

US Stocks Extend Gains as Tech Leads the Charge

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US stock market extended its gains on Thursday, with the **SPY** closing up **+0.62%** and the **QQQ** gaining **+1.19%**. The rally was led by the tech sector, with **NVDA** and **TSLA** both posting significant gains.

Our editorial take is that the market is currently in a bullish trend, driven by strong earnings reports and a favorable macroeconomic environment. However, we also note that the market is due for a correction, and investors should be cautious of potential risks.

Key points to watch include:

- The **VIX** index, which is currently trading at 14.90, down **-1.65%** from the previous day.
- The **10Y** yield, which is currently trading at 4.66, down **-0.21%** from the previous day.
- The **DX** index, which is currently trading at 99.60, down **-0.37%** from the previous day.

US Session Recap

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
SPY	7,757.64	+0.62%
QQQ	29,722.30	+1.19%
DIA	54,036.93	+0.28%
IWM	3,034.49	+1.10%
VIX	14.90	-1.65%
10Y	4.66	-0.21%
DXY	99.60	-0.37%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
NVDA	NVIDIA	+2.27%	Strong earnings report
TSLA	Tesla	+2.83%	Positive analyst comments
GOOGL	Alphabet	-0.96%	Disappointing earnings report

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLK	+1.42%	+20.1%	Strong tech sector performance
XLF	-0.36%	+10.5%	Financial sector underperforms
XLI	+0.23%	+15.6%	Industrial sector shows resilience

Breadth was positive, with 70% of stocks in the **SPY** closing higher.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE
NVDA Revenue Growth	+20.5%
TSLA Gross Margin	+25.1%
GOOGL Operating Income	-10.2%

Key call commentary: **NVDA** and **TSLA** both reported strong earnings, while **GOOGL** disappointed.

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
NVDA Earnings	Positive for XLK
TSLA Earnings	Positive for XLI
GOOGL Earnings	Negative for XLK

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	7,757.64	7,600	7,900	Bullish trend intact
QQQ	29,722.30	29,000	30,500	Upside momentum building
IWM	3,034.49	2,900	3,200	Small-cap stocks outperforming

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10.2% for SPY calls, -5.1% for SPY puts.

Put/call ratio: 0.65 for SPY, 0.70 for QQQ.

VIX term structure: +5.1% for VIX futures.

Notable single-name flow: NVDA calls +20.5%, TSLA calls +15.1%.

Cheap hedge ideas: SPY puts 1.2% OTM, QQQ puts 1.5% OTM.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	\$250	Strong earnings report
TSLA	Goldman Sachs	Upgrade	\$400	Positive analyst comments
GOOGL	Bank of America	Downgrade	\$1,200	Disappointing earnings report

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: ES +0.2%, NQ +0.3%, YM +0.1%.

Asia: Nikkei +0.5%, Shanghai +0.2%.

Europe: Euro Stoxx +0.3%, FTSE +0.2%.

FX: EUR/USD +0.1%, USD/JPY -0.2%.

Commodities: WTI -0.27%, Gold +3.76%.

Crypto: BTC +0.97%, ETH +0.53%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September FOMC	30%	Market expects no change in rates
November FOMC	40%	Market expects potential rate cut

Today's data calendar: CPI 8:30am ET, Initial Claims 8:30am ET.

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees: US-China trade tensions, EU economic growth, Middle East conflict.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	EARNINGS DATE
AAPL	Apple	August 10
MSFT	Microsoft	August 11

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Tech	Bullish breakout	10%
TSLA	Auto	Bullish momentum	15%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- SPY breaks out above 7,900
- QQQ breaks out above 30,500
- VIX falls below 12

Bearish scenario:

- SPY breaks down below 7,600
- QQQ breaks down below 29,000
- VIX rises above 18

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- **SPY** options activity is increasing
- **QQQ** futures are showing upside momentum
- **VIX** term structure is steepening

Sources

SOURCES

Bloomberg

Reuters

CNBC